LAVENDA OKEY ALELA

Cloud Support Trainee (AWS re/Start) | IT Specialist | IT Support Professional

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

IT specialist with 1+ year of hands-on experience in system administration, networking and on-premises to cloud server migration. Maintained 99% system uptime across 25 health facilities and led server migrations with minimal service disruption. Currently training in AWS Cloud through AWS re/Start (Ajira Digital, Cohort 15) toward the AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner exam, and completing the Deloitte WorldClass program. Seeking a cloud or IT support role where I can apply my Linux, database and cloud migration experience to keep systems reliable and secure.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Specialist (IT Support / Technician) – HJFMRI (PEPFAR Program) **July 2025 – May 2026**
Seme Sub-County, Kisumu, Kenya

- Sustained 99% system uptime across 25 health facilities (including Kombewa, Miranga, Manyuanda, Arito and Ratta hospitals) through proactive monitoring, preventive maintenance and rapid incident response.
- Led the migration of on-premises servers to cloud infrastructure, preserving data integrity and keeping service disruption to a minimum.
- Administered the TaifaCare EMR (OpenMRS-based) on Ubuntu servers, covering installation, configuration and ongoing maintenance.
- Kept the EMR stable by managing Apache Tomcat 9 application lifecycles and Java runtime environments.
- Resolved data synchronization issues and protected data integrity by running regular MySQL database audits.
- Restored and maintained connectivity by configuring and troubleshooting facility networks, including IP addressing, firewall rules and inter-site links.
- Delivered Tier 1–2 helpdesk support, and trained healthcare workers and non-technical staff on EMR use, IT security best practices and standard operating procedures.

ICT Intern – Kenya Marine and Fisheries Research Institute (KMFRI) **May 2025 – June 2025**
Kisumu, Kenya

- Resolved hardware and software issues for research staff by triaging and handling Tier-1 helpdesk requests.
- Improved issue visibility and response time by logging every technical incident in the IT tracking system.
- Configured user workstations and supported accurate, reliable research data entry.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATION

- AWS re/Start – Cloud Practitioner track (Ajira Digital, Cohort 15): in progress, expected completion November 2026. Preparing for the AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner exam.
- Deloitte WorldClass Program: in progress.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Information Technology (BBIT) **May 2026 – Present**
KCA University, Nairobi, Kenya

Diploma in Business Information Technology **Graduated November 2025**
KCA University, Nairobi, Kenya

Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
St. Mary's Mabera Girls, Migori, Kenya

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

- **Cloud & Servers:** On-premises to cloud migration, AWS cloud fundamentals (in training), server administration, system monitoring
- **Operating Systems:** Ubuntu Linux, Windows (all versions)
- **Applications:** TaifaCare EMR (OpenMRS), Apache Tomcat 9, Java runtime management, Microsoft Office (advanced Excel)
- **Networking:** IP configuration, DNS/DHCP, firewall basics, site connectivity troubleshooting
- **Databases:** MySQL, MariaDB – schema management, queries, auditing, synchronization
- **Scripting:** Bash for automation and system maintenance
- **Support & Soft Skills:** Tier 1–2 helpdesk, ticketing systems, end-user training, technical documentation, cross-functional collaboration, adaptability, continuous learning